

Chicago Tribune



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“ICE’s un-American and undemocratic tactics of fear and intimidation in our neighborhoods are a direct attack on everything Chicago stands for — inclusion, compassion and love.”

— Ald. Bennett Lawson, 44th, whose North Side district was among those in Chicagoland raided on Friday



Federal agents detain a man and load him into a passenger van outside Carpentersville Village Hall on Oct. 15. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Judge poised to release at least some arrestees

Federal immigration agents tear-gas Lakeview despite order against tactic, raid Lincoln Park as incursion focuses on affluent North Side

By Gregory Royal Pratt and Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

For most of the fall, President Donald Trump’s immigration agents have set out every day to scour Chicago neighborhoods where immigrants live. On Friday, Operation Midway Blitz fanned out across the wealthier white communities on the North Side where they work.

Throughout the day, caravans of federal agents hit neighborhoods that had so far avoided serious confrontations.

In Lakeview, agents threw tear gas into the street, even as their use of chemical agents has drawn intense scrutiny from a federal judge. Masked officials arrested a man at the Laugh Factory comedy club. They detained a man at a gas station near the tony Latin School where the city’s elite send their children.

A spokesperson for the U.S. Department of Homeland Security did not immediately return a request for comment. But



Dozens of residents surround McPherson Elementary School in the Lincoln Square neighborhood in Chicago after reports of ICE activity in the area on Friday. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Lincoln Park Ald. Timmy Knudsen, 43rd, said masked immigration agents hit “every corner of the ward” he represents, one of the city’s wealthiest communities.

A video taken at Racine and Schubert avenues shows four agents surrounding a Latino man and leading him away from

million-dollar properties, placing him into an SUV and driving off.

Ald. Scott Waguespack, 32nd, said agents grabbed a landscaper and two construction workers and appeared to be going through side streets picking up

Turn to Raids, Page 4

Litigation continues over consent decree

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A Chicago federal judge appeared poised Friday to order at least a portion of the thousands of people detained in Operation Midway Blitz released on electronic monitoring while litigation continues over whether immigration officials have violated a consent decree restricting so-called warrantless arrests.

U.S. District Judge Jeffrey Cummings asked for simultaneous briefs next week that will lay out how many of the some 3,000 people arrested since early September would qualify for automatic detention under federal law, including those with prior criminal convictions or removal orders, as well as others that federal law enforcement argues should stay in custody as a safety threat.

The plaintiffs have accused federal officials of repeatedly breaking the terms of the consent decree and asked that Cummings issue a blanket order releasing most of the detainees on ankle monitoring. The government, meanwhile, said plaintiffs were trying to “paint with a broad brush” and

Turn to Judge, Page 4

Harvey launches sweeping furloughs

In response to fiscal crisis, town lays off 40% of employees

By Evy Lewis
Daily Southtown

Harvey furloughed about 40% of city workers this week, following Mayor Christopher Clark’s announcement Oct. 16 the city would partially shut down services as a consequence of its financial situation becoming untenable. Harvey is \$164 million in debt, Clark said.

Harvey’s total workforce is 167, and 69 employees were furloughed, leaving 98 to maintain the essential operations of government. That includes nearly half the Fire Department, with 20 out of 41 total employees furloughed, and more than a third of the Police Department, with 24 out of 68 employees furloughed, according to city documents.

“We are trying our very level best to operate in good faith with the city,” said Keith Freeman, secretary of Harvey Firemen’s Association Local 471.

Freeman declined to comment further, saying union negotiations with the city were ongoing.

A city statement said Fire Station No. 1 would remain open while Stations No. 2 and No. 3 would be temporarily closed. A GoFundMe collecting donations for laid-off firefighters had \$34,000 of its \$100,000 goal as of Friday morning.

Clark said he had conversations with mayors of surrounding communities about fire response. It is already the case, he said, that fire departments respond to emergencies in neighboring communities.

“Some of them I’ve called and some of them have reached out on their own,” Clark said. “And they’ve been very supportive and trying to help as much as they possibly can.”

Much smaller city departments were hit hard, with three of five Water Department employees furloughed, and both of the city’s senior services employees, though Clark said one of the senior services employees had actually retired.

“What we really want is for our residents to understand

Turn to Harvey, Page 2

\$164M

With south suburban Harvey \$164 million in debt, the city has listed several possibilities for potential financial stabilization, including proposed legislation in Springfield that would provide emergency relief.

Pritzker against remote learning for CPS students amid raids

Mayor Brandon Johnson urged Gov. JB Pritzker on Friday to weigh allowing Chicago Public Schools students to learn from home because ICE agents are arresting parents and students on their way to and from schools. Pritzker later took a dim view of the idea, saying kids belong in classrooms and pointing to ways schools and residents have already taken steps to protect students and their parents from raids. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

US sending carrier to Latin America in military escalation

By Konstantin Toropin
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The U.S. military is sending an aircraft carrier to the waters off South America, the Pentagon announced Friday, in the latest escalation of military firepower in a region where the Trump administration has unleashed more rapid strikes in recent days against boats it accuses of carrying drugs.

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth ordered the USS Gerald R. Ford and its strike group to deploy to the U.S. Southern Command region to “bolster U.S. capacity to detect, monitor, and disrupt illicit actors and activities that compromise the safety and prosperity of the United States,” Pentagon spokesman Sean Parnell said on social media.

Hours before Parnell announced the news, Hegseth said the military had conducted the 10th strike on a suspected drug-running boat, leaving six people dead and bringing the death count for the attacks that began in early September to at least 43 people.

Hegseth said on social media that the vessel struck overnight was operated by the Tren de Aragua gang. It was the second time the Trump administration has tied one of its operations to the gang that originated in a Venezuelan prison.

“If you are a narco-terrorist smuggling drugs in our hemisphere, we will treat you like we treat Al-Qaeda,” Hegseth said in his post. “Day or NIGHT, we will map your networks, track your people, hunt you down, and kill you.”

The USS Ford, which has five destroyers in its strike group, is now deployed to the Mediterranean Sea. One of its destroyers is in the Arabian Sea and another is in the Red Sea, a person familiar with the operation told The Associated Press. As of Friday, the aircraft carrier was in port in Croatia on the Adriatic Sea.

The person, who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive military operations, would not say how long it would take for the strike group to arrive in the waters off South America or if all five destroyers would make the journey.

Deploying an aircraft carrier will surge major additional resources to a region that has already seen

Turn to Carrier, Page 6



Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth ordered the USS Gerald R. Ford and its strike group to deploy to Latin America amid what the Trump administration claims is an anti-cartel mission. **ALYSSA JOY/US NAVY**

